



MOAR!

DEVELOPER

343 Industries

PUBLISHER

Xbox Game Studios

PLATFORMS

Xbox Series X and
Series S, Xbox One,
Microsoft Windows

PLAYED ON

Microsoft Windows

PRICE

₹3,999 (Xbox)

versing around the ring a joy, as you grappleshot just about everything and spider-man your way across the map. You can also grappleshot vehicles to automatically drive them.

The targets or boss fights we mentioned earlier make for some of the best content Halo Infinite has to offer, managing to walk that fine line between being both challenging and fun. As a plus, beating them will also unlock new unique weapons in your arsenal.

As you recapture FOBs, the map shows more points of interest for you to explore, and on your way to them, you can come across other interesting stuff, like propaganda radio towers, captured UNSC marines, and even collectibles that unlock cosmetics for the multiplayer mode.

Speaking of FOBs, you can quick-travel to them, and replenish

your ammo and access your arsenal of unlocked weapons at them. You can also call vehicles in here, and there's a long list to choose from. Just keep in mind, TANKS BEAT EVERYTHING!!

Jokes aside, vehicles are pretty stronk in Halo Infinite, I personally preferred traveling on foot and grapple-shotting my way around, but some vehicles are worth it just for the firepower.

You won't have access to everything right off the bat though. Doing activities on the map will earn you valor points, which unlocks more weapons and vehicles for you to use at FOBs.

In addition to the collectibles we mentioned above, littered throughout the world are Spartan Cores. You will use them to upgrade your equipment. As you progress through the game, you will unlock more equipment like the grapple-shot, such as a drop shield, or thrusters. With Spartan Cores these can be upgrades. For instance, the grappleshot can be upgraded to stun enemies, while the thrusters can be upgraded to make you invisible for a few seconds on use.

All of the above is a tried and tested open-world formula that we've seen in just about every Ubisoft game in the last decade, but again, Halo Infinite pulls it off fantastically, by not crowding you with stuff to do, or being too monotonous.

STORY

Like I mentioned in the intro, I haven't followed the story of the Halo fran-

chise, and from what I've heard and seen online, it was all good up to Halo 4. Then Halo 5 came along and it was a crime to gamerkind. You didn't even play as Master Chief for most of the game! Imagine that. Halo Infinite makes an effort to bring things back on track, by trying to tie-up loose ends from Halo 5, and attempting to get a new story going.

That's a hard task, and it shows. However, Halo Infinite still manages to be compelling enough to keep you going all the way. This, largely, has to do with the dynamic between Master Chief and his new AI, Weapon. Throughout the story, you see the relationship between the Chief and Weapon grow, and the banter between them is excellent.

The story revolves around The Banished, a faction that split off from the Covenant. This is where a bit of a problem arises, you may be familiar with them if you have been following the franchise, however, if you're new (like me) you have no clue how we got here. Who are the Covenant? What happened to Cortana? Why did she go rogue? And other such questions. The game does little to answer these questions. A story-so-far cinematic would have been nice.

SOUND AND GRAPHICS

You should listen to the Halo theme while reading this review. That's a banger. Just like the rest of the accompanying music. Both Steve Downes, who reprises his role as the Master Chief, and Jen Taylor, who voices Weapon (she also voiced Cortana btw) have done an excellent job.

Coming to the graphics, the game looks really good. That being said, some more environmental variety in Zeta Halo (the Ring) would have been nice.

VERDICT

Halo Infinite is some of the most fun I've had in an open-world game in a long time. This is an excellent shooter, with plenty of challenges and the freedom to approach things the way you want. The only thing lacking in Halo Infinite is the main story, which despite great characters and casting, falls a bit short. It's certainly still a massive step-up from Halo 5. If things keep going this way though, the future of Halo looks bright. *

